

MICHAEL J. MACDONALD

Senior Systems Administrator | DevOps & Cloud Infrastructure Automation

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CORE SKILLS

- Cloud & Infrastructure as Code
- Ansible / Ansible Automation Platform (AAP)
 - Puppet / Foreman
 - Salt (SaltStack)
 - Red Hat Satellite
 - Terraform (vSphere, AWS, F5 BIG-IP LTM)
 - AWS (Landing Zone Accelerator, IAM, VPC)
- Containers & Orchestration
- Red Hat OpenShift (Kubernetes)
 - Docker / Podman
- Virtualization & Systems
- VMware ESXi / vSphere
 - Red Hat Enterprise Linux (RHEL)
 - Rocky Linux / CentOS
 - Linux / Unix Variants
 - Cisco UCS, HP ProLiant, Dell PowerEdge
- CI/CD & Version Control
- GitHub Actions
 - Jenkins
 - Git / GitLab / GitHub / SVN
- Monitoring & Logging
- Splunk / Elasticsearch / Syslog-ng
 - Nagios / Icinga
 - CrowdStrike Falcon (endpoint sensor)
- Networking, Storage & Identity
- F5 BIG-IP LTM / GTM
 - NetApp OnTap
 - EMC Networker
 - Active Directory / LDAP
 - Microsoft Entra ID (authentication)
 - Duo Security (MFA)
 - Shibboleth / SAML
 - CyberArk Conjur (secrets management)
- Web & Application
- Apache / Nginx
- Languages & Scripting
- Python, YAML, Bash, Perl
 - HTML / CSS / XML
 - Working knowledge: PowerShell, C, C++

CERTIFICATIONS

- Red Hat Certified System Administrator (RHCSA)
- Cert #140-192-733
- Microsoft Certified Systems Administrator (MCSA)
- Cert #5619998
- Microsoft Certified Professional
- MCP, MCDST, MCTS

EDUCATION

Salem State College
Salem, MA
Coursework completed: 56 credits, 2003–2006
Cumulative GPA: 3.508

PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Systems Administrator with 15+ years of enterprise infrastructure experience, evolving toward a DevOps-focused practice built on infrastructure as code, automation, and configuration management. Author Terraform modules to provision infrastructure across vSphere, AWS, and F5 BIG-IP; leading a Puppet-to-Ansible Automation Platform (AAP) migration managing roughly 700 RHEL virtual machines; contributor to AWS Landing Zone Accelerator deployment in a multi-account environment. Proven track record supporting mission-critical, large-scale virtualized infrastructure (1,000+ servers) for a major research university.

EXPERIENCE

- Senior Systems Administrator
- Dec 2013 - Present
- Tufts University, Tufts Technology Services — Somerville, MA
- Administer enterprise-wide virtualized infrastructure spanning 1,000+ servers on Cisco UCS hardware, NetApp FC SAN storage, and VMware vSphere hypervisors, supporting services for the entire university.
 - Author and maintain Terraform configurations to provision and manage infrastructure as code across vSphere, AWS, and F5 BIG-IP LTM, standardizing deployments across on-premises and cloud environments.
 - Lead the ongoing migration from Puppet to Ansible Automation Platform (AAP), refactoring legacy Puppet code into Ansible playbooks to manage a fleet of approximately 700 RHEL virtual machines.
 - Deploy and support Red Hat OpenShift (Kubernetes) on VMware vSphere to run containerized workloads.
 - Contributed to deployment and support of AWS Landing Zone Accelerator in a multi-account AWS environment, including IAM configuration and VPC networking.
 - Perform full-lifecycle RHEL system administration, including installation, patching and package management, compiling open-source software, troubleshooting, monitoring, user account management, and backups.
 - Support DevOps-style CI/CD for a load-balanced, Nginx-based Drupal hosting environment, using Jenkins and Git for automated build and deployment pipelines.
- Senior Operations & Systems Specialist
- Oct 2011 - Dec 2013
- Tufts University, Tufts Technology Services — Somerville, MA
- Delivered enterprise support, systems administration, and infrastructure design and planning for centralized services used university-wide.
 - Managed Group Policy Objects (GPOs), OS image configuration and deployment, and application packaging.
 - Served as technical liaison for campus-wide IT projects in partnership with business and academic units and schools.
- Information Technology Analyst
- Mar 2010 - Oct 2011
- Tufts University, Financial Information Systems — Somerville, MA
- Supported PeopleSoft applications, internal LAMP-stack web applications, and network share (ACL) management for financial reporting systems.
 - Led a hardware refresh cycle and Windows 7 / Office 2010 deployment project; provided systems administration, application packaging and deployment, and tier 3 desktop support for the Finance Division.
- Desktop Support Technician
- Aug 2008 - Mar 2010
- Tufts University, Information Technology Services — Somerville, MA
- Provided desktop and network support for the Fletcher School of Law and Diplomacy, including tier 2/3 support for VIP clients under an on-call rotation.
- Systems Administrator
- Sep 2007 - Aug 2008
- Pepper Hamilton LLP, Multi-practice Law Firm — Boston, MA
- Delivered on-site network support, systems administration, and desktop support; administered Active Directory user accounts, Exchange mailboxes, Group Policy, login scripts, and network share ACLs.
 - Managed daily backups and tape rotation across all servers using Backup Exec and CommVault; provided tier 3 application and network support for attorneys and staff in a 24/7 on-call rotation.